

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

----- X

ERICA CROWE,

SUMMONS:

Plaintiff,

Index No: _____

-against-

Date Filed: _____

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD P.O. MOISES
CONTRERAS; NYPD P.O. JOHN OR JANE DOES 1-10;
individual defendants sued in their
individual and official capacities,

Basis of Venue: Location of
incident: Bronx County

Defendants. **Jury Trial Demanded**

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YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to appear and to answer the Complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer on Plaintiff's attorney within twenty (20) days of the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within thirty (30) days after service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York), and in case of your failure to appear or to answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the Complaint.

DATED: NEW YORK, NY
SEPTEMBER 10, 2020



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Attorney for Plaintiffs
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DEFENDANTS ADDRESS:

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New York, NY 10007

NYPD P.O. MOISES CONTRERAS
NYPD P.O. JOHN or JANE DOES #1-10
NYPD 44th Precinct
2 E 169th St, The Bronx, NY 10452

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

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ERICA CROWE,

Plaintiff,

COMPLAINT

-against-

Index No: _____

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD P.O. MOISES
CONTRERAS; NYPD P.O. JOHN OR JANE DOES 1-10;
individual defendants sued in their
individual and official capacities,

Basis of Venue:
Location of incident:
Bronx County

Defendants. **Jury Trial Demanded**

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The Plaintiff, ERICA CROWE, by and through counsel William
Igbokwe, Esq. of IGBOKWE, PLLC and Martin Adams, Esq. of ADAMS &
COMMISSIONG LLP, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights, common law, and tort action in which Plaintiff seeks relief for the violation of his rights secured by the laws of the State of New York; New York State Constitution; 42 U.S.C. §§ 1983 and 1988; and the Fourth, Sixth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution. Plaintiff's claims arise from an incident that arose on or about June 15, 2019. During the incident, the City of New York, and members of the New York City Police Department ("NYPD") subjected Plaintiff to, among other things, unlawful search and seizure, false arrest and imprisonment, malicious prosecution, negligence, failure to intervene, negligent supervision, hiring, monitoring, training and retention of unfit employees, intentional and negligent infliction of emotional distress, conversion, and implementation and continuation of an unlawful

municipal policy, practice, and custom. Plaintiff seeks compensatory and punitive damages from the individual Defendants, compensatory damages from the municipal Defendant, declaratory relief, an award of costs and attorney's fees, and such other and further relief as the Court deems just and proper.

JURISDICTION & VENUE

2. Within 90 days of the conclusion of the incidents alleged in this complaint, Plaintiff served upon Defendant City of New York a Notice of Claim setting forth the name and post office address of Plaintiff, the nature of the claim, the time when, the place where and the manner in which the claim arose and the items of damages or injuries claimed.

3. More than 30 days have elapsed since Plaintiff's demands and/or claims were presented to Defendant City of New York for adjustment and/or payment thereof, and the Defendant has neglected and/or refused to make any adjustment and/or payment.

4. This action is being commenced within one year and ninety days of the date of the occurrence herein.

5. Venue is proper in the Supreme Court of the State of New York, Kings County, because the acts in question occurred in the State of New York, Kings County, and the City of New York is subject to personal jurisdiction in Supreme Court of the State New York, Kings County.

6. Plaintiff seeks compensatory and punitive damages from the individual Defendants, compensatory damages from the municipal

Defendant, declaratory relief, an award of costs and attorney's fees, and such other and further relief as the Court deems just and proper.

PARTIES

7. Plaintiff Erica Crowe is an African American Female, a resident of the State of New York, Kings County.

8. At all times alleged herein, Defendant City of New York was a municipal corporation organized under the laws of the State of New York, which violated Plaintiff's rights as described herein.

9. At all times alleged herein, Defendants NYPD P.O. Moises Contreras and P.O. John or Jane Does # 1-10 were New York City Police Officers employed with the 44th Precinct, located in Bronx County, New York or other as yet unknown NYPD assignment, who violated Plaintiff's rights as described herein.

10. The individual Defendants are sued in their individual and official capacities.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

11. On June 15, 2019, at and in the vicinity of 1358 Sheridan Avenue, and the 44th Precinct, Bronx, New York, several police officers operating from the 44th Precinct, including upon information and belief, defendants P.O. Moises Contreras and P.O. John or Jane Does # 1-10, at times acting in concert, and at times acting independently, committed the following illegal acts against plaintiff.

12. On June 15, 2019, at and in the vicinity of 1358 Sheridan Avenue, Bronx, New York, which is the home of Plaintiff's sister, 5 to 6 female individuals ("assaulters") forcibly entered the

location and threatened, menaced, and physically assaulted Plaintiff and Plaintiff's sister.

13. During the assault Plaintiff's sister called 911 where NYPD police officers including P.O. Moises Contreras and John or Jane Does # 1-10 later responded to the location.

14. Plaintiff and Plaintiff's sister who called 911 attempted to process a complaint with P.O. Moises and P.O. John or Jane Does # 1-10 who entered the location, who refused and failed to process the Plaintiff and Plaintiff's sister's complaints against the assaulters, where assaulters caused the Plaintiff serious bodily injury including but not limited to multiple contusions about the body and the loss of multiple teeth, but instead arrested Plaintiff in Plaintiff sister's home without probable cause to do so.

15. P.O. Moises and P.O. John or Jane Does # 1-10 actions, and failure to investigate the Plaintiff's sister's complaint, 911 call, Plaintiff's complaint, or to consider the most basic evidence as the Plaintiff's missing teeth and serious bodily injuries caused to Plaintiff by the five (5) assaulters who did not reside at the location or building, and were not lawfully present in the building which was the Plaintiff's sisters home, was a blatant violation of the Plaintiff's due process rights, which caused the sequence of events that ultimately resulted in the arrest and deprivation of Plaintiff's liberty without probable cause to do so.

16. P.O. Moises Contreras and P.O. John or Jane Does # 1-10, placed Plaintiff under arrest, placed her in a police car and took her to the 44th precinct where his arrest was processed.

17. However, because there was no basis to arrest and prosecute the Plaintiff, On November 13, 2019, the case against the Plaintiff was dismissed.

18. The individual Defendants acted in concert committing the above-described illegal acts toward Plaintiff.

19. Plaintiff did not violate any law, regulation, or administrative code; commit any criminal act; or act in a suspicious or unlawful manner prior to or during the above incidents.

20. The Defendants acted under pretense and color of state law and within the scope of their employment. Said acts by said Defendants were beyond the scope of their jurisdiction, without authority or law, and in abuse of their powers, and said Defendants acted willfully, knowingly, and with the specific intent to deprive Plaintiff of his rights.

21. As a direct and proximate result of defendants' actions, plaintiff experienced personal and physical injuries, pain and suffering, fear, humiliation, an invasion of privacy, psychological pain, emotional distress, mental anguish, embarrassment, humiliation, and financial loss

22. Plaintiff is entitled to receive punitive damages from the individual Defendants because the individual Defendants' actions were motivated by extreme recklessness and indifference to Plaintiff's rights.

23. Upon information and belief, the unlawful actions against Plaintiff were also based on profiling.

FIRST CLAIM**(FALSE ARREST UNDER FEDERAL LAW)**

24. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

25. Defendants falsely arrested Plaintiff without consent, an arrest warrant, a lawful search warrant, probable cause, or reasonable suspicion that Plaintiff had committed a crime.

26. Accordingly, Defendants are liable to Plaintiff for false arrest under 42 U.S.C. § 1983; and the Fourth and Fifth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

SECOND CLAIM**(FALSE ARREST UNDER STATE LAW)**

27. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

28. Defendants falsely arrested Plaintiff without consent, an arrest warrant, a lawful search warrant, probable cause, or reasonable suspicion that Plaintiff had committed a crime.

29. Accordingly, Defendants are liable to Plaintiff for false arrest under New York State law.

THIRD CLAIM**(UNLAWFUL SEARCH AND SEIZURE UNDER FEDERAL LAW)**

30. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

31. Defendants unlawfully searched Plaintiff without cause, a warrant, or consent.

32. Accordingly, Defendants are liable to Plaintiff for unlawful search and seizure under 42 U.S.C. § 1983; and the Fourth and Fifth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

FOURTH CLAIM

(UNLAWFUL SEARCH AND SEIZURE UNDER STATE LAW)

33. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

34. Defendants unlawfully searched Plaintiff without cause, a warrant, or consent.

35. Accordingly, Defendants are liable to Plaintiff for unlawful search and seizure under New York State law.

FIFTH CLAIM

(FAILURE TO INTERVENE)

36. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

37. Defendants had a reasonable opportunity to prevent the violations of Plaintiff's constitutional rights, but they failed to intervene.

38. Accordingly, the Defendants are liable to Plaintiff for failing to intervene to prevent the violation of Plaintiff's constitutional rights.

SIXTH CLAIM

(MALICIOUS PROSECUTION UNDER FEDERAL LAW)

39. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

40. The individual defendants are liable to plaintiff for malicious prosecution because prior to any grand action, with intent, knowledge, and malice, the defendants initiated a malicious prosecution against plaintiff by drafting and signing a sworn criminal court complaint and police reports that provided false information to the court, alleging plaintiff had committed various crimes.

41. The individual defendants lacked probable cause to believe the above-stated malicious prosecution could succeed.

42. The individual defendants initiated the above-stated malicious prosecution to cover up their illegal and unconstitutional conduct.

43. The above-stated malicious prosecution caused a sufficient post-arraignment liberty restraint on plaintiff.

44. Accordingly, Defendants are liable to Plaintiff for unlawful search and seizure under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 and the United States Constitution.

SEVENTH CLAIM

(MALCIOUS PROSECUTION UNDER STATE LAW)

45. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

46. Defendants are liable to plaintiff for malicious prosecution because, pursuant to a conspiracy and acting with malice, the defendants initiated a malicious prosecution against plaintiff by knowingly, intentionally, and maliciously providing false statements to prosecutors and/or the criminal court(s), which alleged plaintiff had committed various crimes; and based upon these false statements,

prosecutors prosecuted plaintiff until the case against plaintiff were dismissed in their entirety.

47. The individual defendants lacked probable cause to believe the above-stated malicious prosecution(s) could succeed.

48. The individual defendants acted to cover up their illegal and unconstitutional conduct by initiating the above-stated malicious prosecution(s).

49. Accordingly, Defendants are liable to Plaintiff for malicious prosecution under New York State law.

EIGHTH CLAIM

(NEGLIGENCE)

50. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

51. Defendants are liable to Plaintiff because Defendants owed Plaintiff a cognizable duty of care as a matter of law, and breached that duty.

NINTH CLAIM

**(NEGLIGENT SUPERVISION, HIRING, MONITORING,
TRAINING, AND RETENTION OF UNFIT EMPLOYEES)**

52. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

53. Defendant City of New York is liable to Plaintiff because the occurrence and injuries sustained by Plaintiff, were caused solely by, and as a result of the malicious, reckless, negligent, and/or intentional conduct of Defendant City of New York, and the NYPD, its agents, servants and/or employees, as set forth above, without provocation on the part of Plaintiff contributing

thereto, specifically, the negligent and reckless manner in which said Defendant hired, trained, supervised, controlled, managed, maintained, inspected, and retained its Police Officers.

TENTH CLAIM

(INTENTIONAL AND NEGLIGENT INFLICTION OF EMOTIONAL DISTRESS)

54. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

55. That by virtue of the occurrence and Defendants, individually and/or by their agents, servants and/or employees, negligently and/or intentionally inflicted emotional harm upon Plaintiff.

56. The Defendants' actions against Plaintiff were extreme and outrageous and caused Plaintiff severe emotional distress.

57. The Defendants breached a duty owed to Plaintiff that either unreasonably endangered Plaintiff's physical safety, or caused Plaintiff to fear for his own safety.

ELEVENTH CLAIM

(MONELL CLAIM)

58. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

59. Defendant City of New York, through a policy, practice and custom, directly caused the constitutional violations suffered by Plaintiff.

60. Defendant City of New York through the NYPD and its officers, committed the following unconstitutional practices, customs and policies against Plaintiff: (1) unlawfully searching innocent

persons; (2) wrongfully arresting innocent persons in order to meet productivity goals; (3) wrongfully arresting individuals based on pretexts and profiling; and (4) fabricating evidence against innocent persons.

61. Upon information and belief, Defendant City of New York, at all relevant times, was aware that the Defendants were unfit officers who have previously committed the acts alleged herein, have a propensity for unconstitutional conduct, or have been inadequately trained.

62. Nevertheless, Defendant City of New York exercised deliberate indifference by failing to take remedial action. The City failed to properly train, retrain, supervise, discipline, and monitor the individual Defendants and improperly retained and utilized them. Moreover, upon information and belief, Defendant City of New York failed to adequately investigate prior complaints filed against the individual Defendants.

63. Further, Defendant City of New York was aware prior to the incident that the individual Defendants (in continuation of its illegal custom, practice and/or policy) would stop, arrest and prosecute innocent individuals, based on pretexts and false evidence.

64. The existence of the aforesaid unconstitutional customs and policies may be inferred from repeated occurrences of similar wrongful conduct involving the individual Defendants, placing the Defendant City of New York on notice of the individual Defendants' propensity to violate the rights of individuals.

65. In addition to frequently violating the civil rights of countless residents of New York City, numerous members of the NYPD commit crimes. Officers have been arrested and convicted of such crimes as planting evidence on suspects, falsifying police reports, perjury, corruption, theft, selling narcotics, smuggling firearms, robbery, fixing tickets, driving under the influence of alcohol, vehicular homicide, assault and domestic violence. In fact, former NYPD Commissioner Bernard Kerik was convicted of corruption-related crimes in federal and state courts and served time in federal prison. In 2011, Brooklyn South Narcotics Officer Jerry Bowens was convicted of murder and attempted murder in Supreme Court, Kings County, while under indictment for corruption and is presently serving a life sentence. In 2011, Police Officer William Eiseman and his subordinate Police Officer Michael Carsey were convicted of felonies in Supreme Court, New York County, for lying under oath, filing false information to obtain search warrants and performing illegal searches of vehicles and apartments. In 2012, New York City Police Officer Michael Pena was convicted in Supreme Court, New York County, of raping and sexually assaulting a woman at gunpoint and is presently serving a sentence of 75 years to life.

66. The foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of the City of New York and the NYPD were the direct and proximate cause of the constitutional violations suffered by Plaintiff as alleged herein.

67. The foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of the City of New York and the NYPD were the

moving force behind the constitutional violations suffered by Plaintiff as alleged herein.

68. The City's failure to act resulted in the violation of Plaintiff's constitutional rights as described herein.

TWELTH CLAIM

(RESPONDEAT SUPERIOR)

69. Plaintiff repeats and realleges all the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

70. The individual Defendants were acting within the scope of their employment as New York City Police Officers when they committed the above described acts against Plaintiff.

71. The City of New York is therefore vicariously liable under New York State law for the aforesaid torts.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands a jury trial and the following relief jointly and severally against the Defendants:

- a. Compensatory damages in an amount to be determined by a jury;
- b. Punitive damages in an amount to be determined by a jury;
- c. Costs, interest and attorney's fees, pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988; and
- d. Such other and further relief as this Court may deem just and proper, including injunctive and declaratory relief.

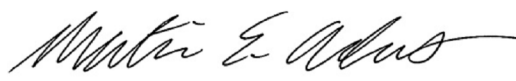
DATED: New York, New York
September 10, 2020

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MARTIN E. ADAMS, ESQ.

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

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ERICA CROWE,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD P.O. MOISES
CONTRERAS; NYPD P.O. JOHN OR JANE DOES 1-10;
individual defendants sued in their
individual and official capacities,

Defendants.

----- X

STATE OF NEW YORK

ss.:

COUNTY OF BRONX

O. Williams Igbokwe, Esq, an attorney-at-law, duly admitted to practice law in the State of New York, hereby affirms pursuant to the C.P.L.R. and subscribing as true under the penalties of perjury as follows:

That the Affirmant is a member of the law firm Igbokwe, PLLC the attorneys of record for the Plaintiff in the above entitled action.

That the Affirmant has read the foregoing complaint and knows the contents thereof; that the same is true to his knowledge, except as to the matters stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and that as to those matters he believes them to be true.

That the reason why this verification is made by Affirmant instead of the Plaintiff is because the Plaintiff does not reside within the County in which the firm of Igbokwe, PLLC maintain their office.

The grounds of Affirmant's belief as to all matters in the complaint not stated to be upon his knowledge are based upon conversations with Plaintiff, and a review of records related to this action.

DATED: New York, New York
September 10, 2020

O. Williams Igbokwe, ESQ

VERIFICATION

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No: _____

Date

Filed: _____